

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Poner Summary

Skool.com/qroo

In this lesson, we explore the versatile Spanish verb *poner*, which usually means “to put” but appears in many other useful constructions. The video touches on various tenses and moods, including the **preterite**, **imperative**, **subjunctive**, and **pronominal form** (*ponerse*), with practical examples throughout.

1. Poner = to put (physically place something somewhere)

Most commonly, *poner* means to place something. Example:

- ¿Dónde pusiste las llaves? = Where did you put the keys?
- Puse las flores en la cocina. = I put the flowers in the kitchen.

We often use *poner* in the **preterite** tense for completed actions:

Preterite conjugation of PONER (irregular):

Yo	Tú	Él / Ella / Usted	Nosotros	Vosotros	Ellos / Ustedes
puse	pusiste	puso	pusimos	pusisteis	pusieron

Examples:

- ¿Dónde pusiste los platos? = Where did you put the plates?
- Los puse en la mesa. = I put them on the table.

Note: Direct object pronouns like *los*, *las*, *lo*, *la* are placed before the conjugated verb.

2. Imperative Mood (Commands)

Used for telling someone to put something somewhere.

Tú form (informal):

- Affirmative: *pon*
 - Pon las llaves en la mesa. = Put the keys on the table.

- Negative: *no pongas*
 - No pongas las llaves en la mesa. = Don't put the keys on the table.

Usted form (formal):

- Both affirmative and negative: *ponga*
 - Ponga las llaves en la mesa. = (You formal) Put the keys on the table.
 - No ponga las llaves en la mesa. = Don't put the keys on the table.

Note: Affirmative commands attach pronouns (e.g., *ponlas*), and negative commands keep them in front (*no las pongas*).

3. Poner with Subjunctive Trigger

A common subjunctive trigger is *¿Quieres que...?* = Do you want me to...?

Since *poner* is irregular in the present subjunctive, here's the conjugation:

Yo	Tú	Él / Ella / Usted	Nosotros	Vosotros	Ellos / Ustedes
ponga	pongas	ponga	pongamos	pongáis	pongan

Examples:

- *¿Quieres que ponga las maletas en el coche?* = Do you want me to put the suitcases in the car?
 - *¿Quieres que ponga la mesa?* = Do you want me to set the table?
-

4. Indirect Object + Poner (used with food and drinks)

Phrases like *¿Qué le pusiste a...?* = What did you put in/on it?

- *¿Qué le pusiste a la sopa?* = What did you put in the soup?
- *Le puse sal.* = I put salt in it.

Here, *le* refers to the soup (indirect object), and *sal* is the direct object.

5. Poner + Adjective (emotional states)

Use *poner* to express emotional impact: “to make [someone] feel...”

- Las noticias me pusieron triste. = The news made me sad.
- Las mentiras me ponen furioso. = Lies make me furious.

Poner must match the subject, and the adjective must agree with the person affected.

6. Ponerse = to become / to put on clothing (pronominal form)

Use *ponerse* to talk about emotional or physical states you enter into, or when putting on clothes.

- Me puse feliz al verte. = I became happy when I saw you.
- Nos pusimos nerviosos. = We got nervous.
- Ella se puso un vestido rojo. = She put on a red dress.

Commands with reflexive pronouns:

- Ponte la camisa blanca. = Put on the white shirt.
 - No te pongas la camisa roja. = Don't put on the red shirt.
-

7. Common Expressions with PONER

- *Poner a prueba* = to put to the test
 - Vamos a poner tu español a prueba. = We're going to put your Spanish to the test.
 - *Poner la mesa* = to set the table
 - Los niños siempre ayudan a poner la mesa.
 - *Poner en marcha* = to start up / set in motion
 - Vamos a poner en marcha el nuevo proyecto.
 - *Poner huevos* = to lay eggs
 - La gallina puso dos huevos. = The hen laid two eggs.
-

Closing Notes:

This lesson is packed with useful applications of *poner*. Practice using it in different tenses and moods. Focus first on the present and preterite, then expand into commands and the subjunctive.